"NRC Decommissioning Public Engagement Experiences"

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Bruce A. Watson CHP

Marlayna Doell

Office of Nuclear Material Security and Safeguards

Division of Decommissioning, Uranium Recovery and Waste Programs

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NRC Strategic Plan Goals

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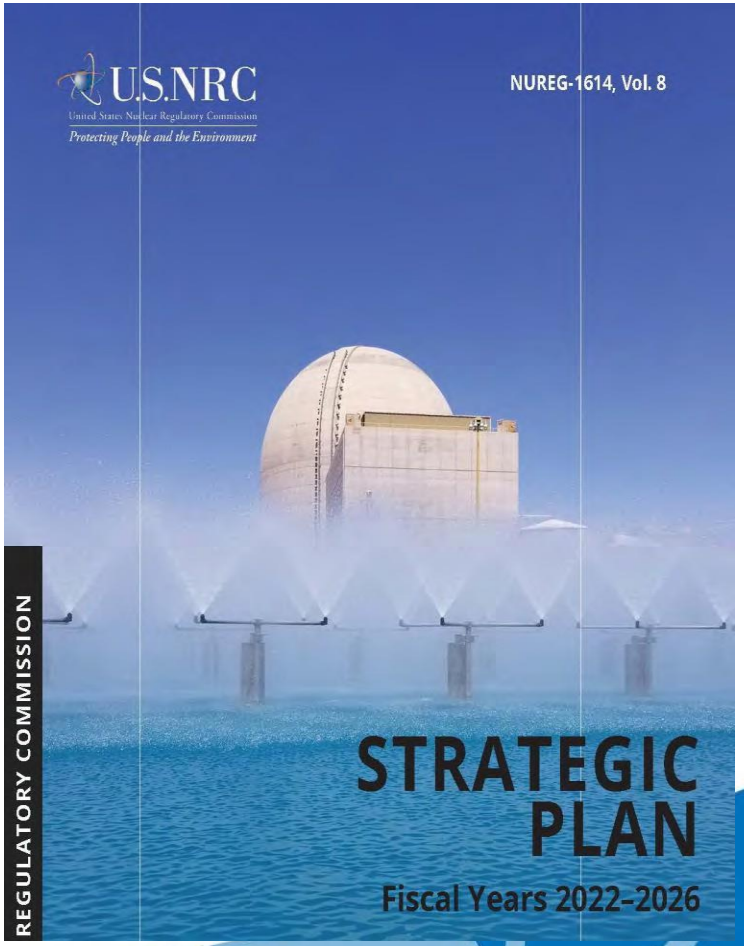
- Safety and Security
- Organizational Health
- Stakeholder Confidence



NRC sponsors public meetings to hear views of local communities/interested parties/stakeholders

- New license Applications
- Plant Operations Annual Assessments
- New Regulations / Rule Makings
- License Amendment Process
- Environmental Reviews
- Decommissioning PSDAR and LTP Meetings

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NRC holds public meetings to hear public concerns:

- Nuclear safety issues
- Radiological safety issues
- Environmental issues
- Security issues

Interested Stakeholders/Parties

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- U. S. Congress
- Native American Tribal Nations
- State and Local Governments
- State Officials, Legislatures
- Licensee or State sponsored Decommissioning Community Advisory Boards/Citizen Engagement Panels
- Non-government Organizations
- Interested Citizens
- Industry/licensees

The States Roles in Decommissioning

- States regulate their energy markets and approve new generation sites and setting electric rates
- States may license low level radioactive waste disposal sites in accordance with NRC regulations 10 CFR 61
- The NRC's National Materials Program allows States to become NRC-Agreement States to regulate medical, industrial and research facilities, including the decommissioning of those facilities
- For NRC licensed decommissioning sites, States can enter into agreements with the licensees for the safe decommissioning of the sites and restoration of the sites

Public Views on Nuclear Issues are Diverse

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Public interest, views of interested parties, and participation in nuclear issues are generally dependent on the Region and may be State specific.

NRC decision-making is based on Safety and Security for ensuring safety of the public and the environment

Power Reactor Public Concerns

- Offsite Emergency Response Reductions
- Safety of Spent Fuel Pools versus Interim Spent Fuel Storage Installations (ISFSI)
- Long Term High-level Waste Storage and Transportation
- NRC Decommissioning and Spent Fuel Inspection Programs
- Dose Criteria for unrestricted use and license termination

Power Reactors Public Concerns Evolve

- License transfers to Decommissioning Companies
- Decommissioning Trust Fund misuse
- Licensee's decommissioning plans
- Economic losses to the local community
  - Tax revenues
  - High paying jobs
  - Employee volunteers and community involvement
- Fulltime Resident Inspectors and NRC Decommissioning Inspection Program
- Site restoration and future use
- Effluent releases (Tritium)

San Onofre

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- Resident NRC Inspector
- Spent fuel storage location

- SONGS Community Engagement Panel
- Congressional Delegation
- U.S. Navy
- State of California
  - Coastal Commission
  - Energy Commission
  - State Senate
  - Government to Government Meetings

Pilgrim

- Distrust of the decommissioning licensee/company
- Spent Fuel Dry Storage Facility Location
- Effluent releases of Tritium

- Congressional Field Hearing
- Past Governor
- Government to Government Meetings
- Pilgrim Nuclear Decommissioning Citizens Advisory Board

Indian Point

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- Major natural gas pipelines
- Resident Inspectors
- Liquid effluents – Tritium releases

- NY State Legislature
- NY Decommissioning Oversight Board
- Government to Government Meetings
- Congressional Staff

Summary

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- Recommend Licensee's either sponsor or participate in State sponsored community advisory boards
- Know your audience, interface them before the meeting
- If possible, try to keep a balance between people with differing opinions, do not let one group dominate
- Have meeting ground rules and use a facilitator
- Do your best to keep the meeting under civil and under control by listening and confirm you heard the comment.
- Where appropriate, have local law enforcement in attendance
- Expect the unexpected, sometimes you may be surprised
- To let the audience know you listened, the leader should close the meeting with a high-level summary of the comments from the public